Dr. Corey Ford

PhD QMUL, BSc(Hons) MRes UWE, AFHEA
Lecturer in Computer and Data Science

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Education

2020-2025	**Queen Mary University of London** PhD in Artificial Intelligence and Music (HCI) Thesis Title: *Reflection in Creativity Support Tool Interaction: Characterisations for AI-based Music Composition*
2019-2020	**The University of the West of England** MRes Data Science (HCI), Distinction
2016-2019	**The University of the West of England** BSc(Hons) Creative Music Technology (JAMES accredited), First class
2009-2016	**Cox Green Secondary School** A-Level Mathematics, Music and Media – Grade B
2005-2014	**FunTech Computing School** A-Level Computing (Aged 15) and GCSE ICT (Aged 12) – Grade A

Employment

Aug 2025-present — **Lecturer in Computer and Data Science** (University of the Arts London)
On the BSc(Hons) Computer Science and AI and Data Science degrees.

Apr-Jul 2024 — **Post-Doctoral Research Assistant** (University of the Arts London)
Worked with a London AI music start-up company to co-design interfaces for responsive generative AI. Part-time.

Summer 2023 — **Research Assistant (Autoethnography)** (Queen Mary University of London)
Conducted an in-depth autoethnographic investigation of incorporating an explainable AI plugin into my band's creative practice of composing punk rock music.

2022-2024 — **Teaching Fellow** (Queen Mary University of London)
Lecturing for User Experience Design (Level 6 & 7, 180+ students). Student feedback:

- *"Corey Ford has been my favourite lecturer in the last 3 years of QMUL education."*
- *"Corey was incredibly supportive throughout the module. Constantly and consistently assisting students throughout labs [. . .] He seems truly dedicated to maximizing students' potential by keeping learning important and fun at the same time."*
- *"Really enjoyed how conversational Corey's lectures were and how he got the class interacting."*
- *"Corey was a part of this module and he truly made the part for me and my team's and other student's final semester at Queen Mary."*

Wrote and developed all course material for a **HCI Research Methods** module (Level 7). Student feedback includes:

- *"It is helpful to cover content that is relevant to the MSc Project. Corey does a great job of running lectures!"*
- *"Structure of the course is good."*
- *"Very interactive and covered sufficient content in a single lecture which made it easier to grasp the topics easily".*

Developed course material for a **GUI web development** module (Level 5), walking students through **Figma** to **HTML** & **CSS**, to **React**.

Duties included: preparing and delivering lectures; preparing and delivering 'drop-in' style lab sessions; organisation, training and supervision of 8 demonstrators; organisation and moderation of coursework marking; updating teaching materials and module VLE course pages; running office hours; and supporting student queries throughout the teaching term.

2020-2023 **Demonstrator** (Queen Mary University of London)
Assisted teaching, assessment and administration (e.g. liaison with finance) across the university's computer science and creative engineering degrees, for the following modules:

- Design for Human Interaction (Level 6 and 7)
- Interaction Design (Level 6 and 7)
- Creative Group Project (Level 5) ***winner of Sustainability Award 2023**
- Arts Application Programming (Level 4)

Summer 2021 **Research Assistant (Explainable AI)** (Queen Mary University of London)
Worked in a team to undertake a survey of AI systems which support co-creation of music between humans and machines, reviewing a number of creative AI systems from a user- centred perspective and developing a taxonomy based on how people interact with them.

2019-2021 **Associate Lecturer** (The University of The West of England)
Contributed to lecturing, teaching, assessment (*= and curriculum design) for the BSc(Hons) Music Technology degrees and MSc Data Science degree, on the following modules:

- Programming for Data Science* (Level 7)
- Audio Process Design and Implementation (Level 5)
- Audio Technology* (Level 4)
- Introductory Audio Programming (Level 4)

2018-2020 **Programming Tutor** (The University of The West of England)
Led drop-in sessions for students with programming questions across the university's computer science courses and their varied modules (such as: Intro to C++; Audio Process Design and Implementation; and Data Structures and Algorithms).

Summer 2019 **Research Assistant (Music & Code)** (The University of The West of England)
Supported an iterative design process where functionality, language primitives and improved usability were developed based on my experience of transcribing music as music + code with a novel generative music programming environment, named Manhattan.

Jun-July 2019	**Workshop Lead** (The University of The West of England) Developed teaching materials and led a workshop for A-Level students, introducing them to sound editing. This was for a STEM outreach event (funded by the Institute of Coding).
Summer 2018	**Audio Software Developer Intern** (The University of the West of England) Worked with UWE's Creative Technologies Laboratory, supporting experimental work with their audio development board (ARM M4 & M7 chips), writing real-time C++ and FAUST code.
2017-2018	**Academic PAL Leader** (The University of the West of England) Mentored and facilitated learning for 1st year students in Music Technology (particularly helping with their audio programming in C++). Led to an ILM Level 3 Mentoring Award.
2017-2018	**Tech Tutor** (FunTech) Tutoring holiday tech camps for 8-16-year-olds. These included: Unity Game Development, Lego EV3's, Java, Python, App Design, Object-Oriented Programming & Scratch.
Mar-Apr 2017	**Developer** (FunTech) Wrote course content in C for a "Music Coder" tech camp. I'd pitched the idea with a mini business plan and budget estimation.
2015-2016	**Network Systems Assistant** (Wessex Primary School) Worked as a technician fixing general IT issues around the school.

Publications

:JOURNAL PAPERS:

Lerch, A, Arthur, C, Bryan-Kinns, N, **Ford, C,** Sun, Q, Vinay, A (2025) Survey on the Evaluation of Generative Models in Music. ACM Computing Surveys.

:FULL CONFERENCE PAPERS:

Rezwana, J and **Ford, C** (2025) Human-Centered AI Communication in Co-Creativity: An Initial Framework and Insights. ACM Conference on Creativity and Cognition (C&C). London, UK.

Saitis, C, Del Sette, BM, Shier, J, Tian, H, Zheng, S, Skach, S, Reed, CN, and **Ford, C** (2024) Timbre Tools: Ethnographic Perspectives on Timbre and Sonic Cultures in Hackathon Designs. ACM Audio Mostly Conference. Milan, Italy.

Bryan-Kinns, N, Noel-Hirst, A and **Ford, C** (2024) Using Incongruous Genres to Explore Music Making with AI Generated Content. ACM Conference on Creativity and Cognition (C&C). Chicago, USA.

Ford, C, Noel-Hirst, A, Cardinale, S, Loth, J, Sarmento, P, Wilson, E, Wolstanholme, L, Worrall, K and Bryan-Kinns, N (2024) Reflection Across AI-based Music Composition. ACM Conference on Creativity and Cognition (C&C). Chicago, USA. ***Honourable Mention Award (top 5% submissions)!**

Ford, C and Bryan-Kinns, N (2023) Towards a Reflection in Creative Experience Questionnaire. ACM Conference on Computer-Human Interaction (CHI). Hamburg, Germany.

Ford, C and Bryan-Kinns, N (2022) Identifying Engagement in Children's Interaction whilst Composing Digital Music at Home. ACM Conference on Creativity and Cognition (C&C). Venice, Italy.

Ford, C, Bryan-Kinns, N and Nash, C (2021) Creativity in Children's Digital Music Composition. International Conference on New Interfaces for Musical Expression (NIME). NYU Shanghai, China.

Ford, C and Nash, C (2020) An Iterative Design by 'Proxy' Method for Developing Educational Music Interfaces. International Conference on New Interfaces for Musical Expression (NIME). Birmingham, UK.

:BOOK CHAPTERS:

Bryan-Kinns, N, Banar, B, **Ford, C**, Reed, CN, Yixiao, Z and Armitage, J (2024) Explainable AI and Music. Artificial Intelligence for Art Creation and Understanding. CRC Press.

:WORKSHOP, SHORT PAPERS AND EXTENDED ABSTRACTS:

Sharma, A, Rodic, A, Saleem, S, Sourie, M and **Ford, C** (2025) Decolonizing Computer Science: Holograms in Holborn. ACM Conference on Creativity and Cognition (C&C). London, UK.

Joshi, N, Bagga, R, Clayton, R, Adan, M, Kalule, J and **Ford, C** (2025) Decolonizing Computer Science: The Immersive Elevator Experience. ACM Conference on Creativity and Cognition (C&C). London, UK.

Ford, C, Wilson, E, Zheng, S, Vigliensoni, G, Rezwana, J, Xiao, L, Clemens, M, Lewis, M, Hemment, D, Chamberlain, A, Kennedy, H, and Bryan-Kinns, N (2025) Explainable AI for the Arts 3 (XAIxArts3). ACM Conference on Creativity and Cognition (C&C). London, UK.

Rezwana, J and **Ford, C** (2025) Improving User Experience with FAICO: Towards a Framework for AI Communication in Human-AI Co-Creativity. Proceedings of the Extended Abstracts of the Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI). Yokohama, Japan.

Bryan-Kinns, N, **Ford, C**, Zheng, S, Kennedy, H, Chamberlain, A, Lewis, M, Hemment, D, Li, Z, Wu, Q, Xiao, L, Xia, G, Rezwana, J, Clemens, M, and Vigliensoni, G. (2024) Explainable AI for the Arts 2 (XAIxArts2). ACM Conference on Creativity and Cognition (C&C). Chicago, USA.

Saitis, C, Del Sette, BM, Tian, H, Shier, J, Zheng, S, Skach, S, Reed, CN, and **Ford, C** (2024) Ethnographic Exploration of Timbre in Hackathon Designs. CHIME Annual Workshop, Milton Keynes, UK.

Lewis, M... **Ford, C** and 38 others (2024) Travelling Arts x HCI Sketchbook: Exploring the Intersection Between Artistic Expression and Human-Computer Interaction. alt.chi at CHI. Hawaii, USA.

Ford, C, Cardinale, S and Bryan-Kinns, N (2023) Three Open Questions for the Design of AI for Music Composition. CHIME One Day Workshop, Milton Keynes, UK.

Bryan-Kinns, N, **Ford, C,** Chamberlain, A, Benford, S, Kennedy, H, Li, Z, Qiong, W, Xia, G and Rezwana, J (2023) Explainable AI for the Arts: XAIxArts. ACM Conference on Creativity and Cognition (C&C).

Ford, C and Bryan-Kinns, N (2023) On the Role of Reflection and Digital Tool Design for Creative Practitioners. Workshop on Digital Skills for the Creative Practitioner: Supporting Informal Learning of Technologies for Creativity at CHI. Hamburg, Germany.

Ford, C and Bryan-Kinns, N (2022) Speculating on Reflection and People's Music Co-Creation with AI. Workshop on Generative AI and HCI at ACM CHI. New Orleans, USA.

Bryan-Kinns, N, Banar, B, **Ford, C**, Reed, CN, Zhang, Y, Colton, S and Armitage, J (2021) Exploring XAI for the Arts: Explaining Latent Space in Generative Music. 1st Workshop on eXplainable AI Approaches for Debugging and Diagnosis at NeurIPS. New Orleans, USA.

Memberships

Associate Fellow of the Higher Education Academy (AFHEA)

Student Member of the Association of Computing Machinery (ACM) & SIGCHI

Early Career Ambassador for the Computer Arts Society (CAS)

Technical Skills

Research	**UX** – User studies, personas, usability testing, user stories, card sorting, wizard-of-oz, ideation, design fiction, prototyping & wireframing, child-computer interaction **Knowledge** – Designing for engagement, designing for reflection, creativity support tools, human-AI interaction, Norman's design principles, ethnography, autoethnography, design justice, NIME **Quantitative Methods** – machine learning, experiment design and analysis; A/B testing; questionnaire development and validation; structural equation modelling; factor analysis; interaction logs; data mining **Qualitative Methods** – think-aloud studies; interviews; video-cued recall; thematic analysis, discourse analysis
Languages	**JavaScript** (audio, GUI, ML); **C++** (interactive systems and embedded); **Python** (data mining, statistics, ML); **LaTeX** (publications); **R** (statistics); **Java**; **HTML**; **CSS**; **Javascript**;
Frameworks	**JUCE** (large-scale multi-threaded applications); **Processing & P5js** (musical interfaces, generative art, web ML); **Web** (React, Tone.js, NPM); **OpenFrameworks** (interactive systems, generative art); **Machine Learning** (TensorFlow, Keras); **Anaconda** (numpy, pandas, matplotlib);
Tools	**GIT; MIDI; BibTex; Doxygen; UML; JSON; XML**
IOT	**Arduino; Raspberry Pi; ESP32; MQTT**

Music	**Sibelius**, **Logic**, **Pro Tools**, **Cubase** & **Reaper**.
	Guitar (grade 8 standard); **Piano** (self-taught); **Music Composition** (portfolio on request).
Other	**OS** (Mac OSX, Windows, Linux); **Applications** (Xcode, Visual Studio, Adobe Creative Suite, MS Office); **Driving** (British driving license).

Extra Curricula Activity

:CONFERENCE ORGANISATION:

2025-2026	Posters and Demos Chair for ACM Creativity and Cognition (C&C)
2023-2024	Student Volunteer Chair for ACM Creativity and Cognition (C&C)
2023	"Reflection" Session Chair for ACM Creativity and Cognition (C&C)
2021	Programme chair & editor for DMRN+16: Digital Music Research Network One-Day Workshop

:WORKSHOP SUPPORT:

2025	Co-Chair for the Explainable AI for the Arts 3 Workshop at ACM Creativity & Cognition 2024
2024	Co-Organiser for the Explainable AI for the Arts 2 Workshop at ACM Creativity & Cognition 2024
2023	Co-Organiser for the Explainable AI for the Arts Workshop at ACM Creativity & Cognition 2023
2022	Volunteer at the International Workshop on Haptic & Audio Interaction Design (HAID)
2020	Workshop support for the BBC Digital Cities Event with Manhattan at the Engine Shed, Bristol
2020	Workshop support for "Crowd Driven Music with Manhattan" at the NIME Conference

:SUPERVISION & MENTORING:

2025	MSc Supervision of Reiner Rillo on Exploring AI Chord Similarities in Music Composition (University of the Arts London)
2021	Supported supervision of 2 MSc Computing and Information Systems (Conversion) Dissertations (Queen Mary University of London)
2018	Awarded an ILM Level 3 Mentoring Certificate

:::ETHICS PANEL:::

2025-present	Creative Computing Institute Research Committee Member (University of the Arts London)
2023-2024	Queen Mary Ethics of Research Committee Member (Devolved School Ethics Committee)

:::OTHER:::

2025-present	Co-organiser of ACM Student Chapter for the Creative Computing Institute at University of the Arts London
2021	Organiser for group lab event between the IRCAM ACIDS lab (France) and the AI + Music CDT (UK)
2020	Student Representative for the AI + Music CDT (Queen Mary University of London)
2019	Student Representative for the MRes Data Science Degree (University of the West of England)

Reviewing

ACM CHI (Full papers; Extended abstracts; alt.chi); **ACM DIS** (ACM Research-Through-Design Committee; Full Papers); **ACM C&C** (Full papers; Pictorials; Artworks; Demos); **Computer Music Journal**; **Personal and Ubiquitous Computing Journal**; **ACM Multimedia** (Artworks); **NIME** (Full papers); **International Workshop on Haptic & Audio Interaction Design** (HAID); **Explainable AI for the Arts Workshop** (XAIxArts); **Digital Music Research Network Workshop** (DMRN).

Invited Talks

EVA and CAS Student Mentoring at the Electronic Visual Arts Conference (2025)

From Code to Chord: Live AI Music at the Music Managers Forum Summit on AI (2023)

ART-ifical Intelligence and Music at the Pint of Science Festival (2022)

On Creativity & Codetta for the School of Computing and Communications at the Open University (2021)

Codetta Talk & Workshop for MA Creative Music Practice students at the University of Gloucestershire (2020)

Awards

Pendlebury-Tucker Prize (Award for Best Music Technology Project) (£200)

Dean’s Award for Academic Excellence 2016/2017 and 2017/2018

Granted funding from the University of the West of England’s enterprise summer scholarship scheme (£1000)

References

References available on request.